Upcoming Releases 2023

Indian

THE ASSASSIN
by K.R. Meera
In November 2016, a woman is attacked by an unknown assailant while returning home. She emerges unharmed. But soon, she realises that this incident might be part of a larger plan to end her life. Once her wheelchair-bound father dies, the plot thickens.

SMOKE AND ASHES: A Writer's Journey Through Hidden Histories
by Amitav Ghosh

Ghosh returns with a new book about China and India, environment, capitalism, opium, tea and history. This wide-ranging work takes on several themes Ghosh has so skilfully tackled in the past.

INSATIABLE; MY HUNGER FOR LIFE
by Shobhaa De

De's book opens with a typically unabashed strike: "I promise not to be three things—profound, pedantic and pretentious." In her 75th year, the writer-columnist-socialite goes on a whirlwind tour of feasting, fine-dining and making merry. From sampling Jaipur's best lassi to an anecdote about M.F. Husain's last wish about food, this layered account promises large helpings of fun.

BOOK OF COMPASSION
by H.H. Dalai Lama and Kailash Satyarthi

Getting two Nobel laureates on the same page can only mean a conversation for the ages. This book plunges into their lives and how compassion moves and motivates these very different men. Built out of research and interviews, it explores what it means to work towards kindness.

A LIFE IN THE SHADOWS: A MEMOIR
by A.S. Dulat
Former head of India's Research and Analysis Wing talks about all things intelligence. From a childhood in Delhi and Lahore to meeting spymasters and world leaders, Dulat's autobiography is about both his personal journey and an insight into a little-known world.

ARYANS: The Search for a People, a Place and a Myth
by Charles Allen
Popular historian of the British Raj, Charles Allen, finished this book just before he died in 2020. Here he examines how connections between Sanskrit and other European languages were first made, and what that discovery meant for scholarship and history. If all of these people were one, who were the Aryans, and where did they come from?

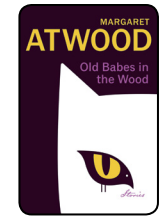
PROTECTION
by Avni Doshi
Having examined a mother-daughter relationship in her debut novel, Doshi now turns her focus on a father-daughter bond. Set between India and the US and spanning decades, *Protection* is told in the voice of the youngest of three children in a family. It is being billed as "a devastating accounting of the economies of love, money and control that circulate through a household".

International

VICTORY CITY
by Salman Rushdie
Promising to be yet another feat of imagination, this latest Rushdie book is set in 14th-century Southern India, where a girl has a divine encounter. When a goddess begins to speak through the child, it has wide implications for empires and the social fabric of the day.

SPARE
by Prince Harry
The pithy title is a reference to the younger prince's role in the family not as an "heir" but as spare, or back-up heir. The tell-all memoir claims to be "up-close, behind the scenes, intimate, and forthright", with Harry telling his story on his terms.

OLD BABES IN THE WOOD
by Margaret Atwood
In this collection of short stories, Atwood strides through a smorgasbord of scenes and themes. Some stories have been previously published and include a tale of two sisters tackling memory and loss, and a fantasy piece on a mother who claims to be a witch.



A DEATH IN TOKYO
by Keigo Higashino
Higashino raises the bar with every book. In *A Death in Tokyo*, a man dies under a mythic statue near the Nihonbashi Bridge. Where was he stabbed and how did he get to the bridge in his final moments?


That very night, another man is caught by the police with the wallet of the victim. Another head-scratcher for Detective Kaga.

THE WAGER
by David Grann
A new Grann title is always a cause for celebration. This time, he focuses on a shipwreck from 1742. A boat with bedraggled men washes up on the shore of Brazil, ostensibly survivors from a British ship on a secret mission. Six months later, another group of survivors shows up, telling a very different tale—that the first group are actually mutineers.

(compiled by Bhavya Dore)